

Anti-Harassment & Workplace Respect Policy

Policy Reference: HR-POL-004

Policy ID:	HR-POL-004	Version:	3.5
Effective Date:	2024-01-01	Last Reviewed:	2023-11-01
Policy Owner:	HR Director	Approved By:	Chief Executive Officer & General Counsel
Compliance Required:	Yes – All Employees	Next Review:	12 months from effective date

1. Policy Statement

Acme Corporation is committed to maintaining a workplace free from harassment, discrimination, and other disrespectful behavior. All employees have the right to work in an environment that promotes dignity, respect, and professional conduct.

2. Prohibited Conduct

Harassment is any unwelcome conduct based on a protected characteristic that: (a) creates an intimidating, hostile, or offensive work environment, or (b) unreasonably interferes with an individual's work performance.

Examples include: sexual comments or jokes, unwanted physical contact, derogatory remarks about protected characteristics, displaying offensive materials, and cyberbullying through company systems.

3. Sexual Harassment

Sexual harassment includes: unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and other verbal, visual, or physical conduct of a sexual nature. Quid pro quo harassment occurs when employment decisions are conditioned on acceptance of sexual conduct. Hostile work environment harassment occurs when sexual conduct is so pervasive or severe that it creates an abusive work environment.

4. Reporting Procedure

Employees who experience or witness harassment must report to: (1) HR Department (hr@company.com), (2) Ethics Hotline (1-800-ETHICS1, anonymous), (3) Skip-level manager if direct manager is involved, (4) Legal Department for urgent situations. Reports should include: date, time, location, description of conduct, names of witnesses, and any documentation.

5. Investigation Process

HR acknowledges all complaints within 24 hours. An impartial investigation is conducted by HR or external investigator. Investigations are completed within 30 days. Both parties interviewed, witnesses identified, documentation reviewed. Findings communicated to complainant and respondent within policy limitations. Interim measures implemented as needed to protect complainant.

6. Confidentiality

Investigations are conducted as confidentially as possible. Information is shared only on a need-to-know basis. Complete confidentiality cannot be guaranteed as investigations require speaking with relevant parties. Employees must cooperate fully and not discuss the investigation with coworkers.

7. Disciplinary Consequences

Substantiated violations result in progressive discipline up to and including immediate termination, regardless of the perpetrator's position or tenure. Factors considered include: severity, frequency, whether conduct continued after warning, and impact on victim.

8. Prevention & Training

All employees complete harassment prevention training annually. Managers complete additional training on identification, response, and investigation. Training completion is tracked and required for performance review completion. The company conducts annual policy reviews to ensure best practices.

9. No Retaliation

Retaliation against any person who reports harassment, participates in an investigation, or exercises rights under this policy is strictly prohibited. Retaliation itself constitutes a separate policy violation and may result in termination.